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Clarity, Direction, Your New Home

THE VISUAL BUYER GUIDE

Buying Your First Property in Singapore (2026)

A 1-page-at-a-time visual companion to the full ProjectHome.sg guide — covering the financial framework, stamp duties, three buying processes and the rules that catch first-time buyers out.

Edition

June 2026

Pages

11

Read time

~10 min

Sources

MAS · IRAS · HDB · CEA

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The 1-minute version

Before you fall for a showflat — settle these three numbers:

TDSR (ALL)

55%

of gross income — total debt cap

MSR (HDB & EC)

30%

mortgage-only cap

LTV (1st loan)

75%

bank financing ceiling

Then budget the upfront cash:

- **5% downpayment in CASH** — the hardest dollar to find
- **20% from CPF OA or cash** — top up to 25% downpayment
- **BSD: 1–6% tiered** — stamped within 14 days of OTP
- **ABSD (if applicable)** — 0% SC 1st · 5% PR 1st · 60% Foreigner
- **Legal: ~\$3,000 + reno buffer 5–7%** — always above the headline price

Then pick your path:

- **NEW LAUNCH CONDO !' IPA · 5% booking · OTP in 3 weeks**
- **RESALE HDB !' HFE letter · \$1,000 OTP · 8 wks to completion**
- **RESALE PRIVATE !' IPA · 1% option · 4% on exercise · 8–10 wks**

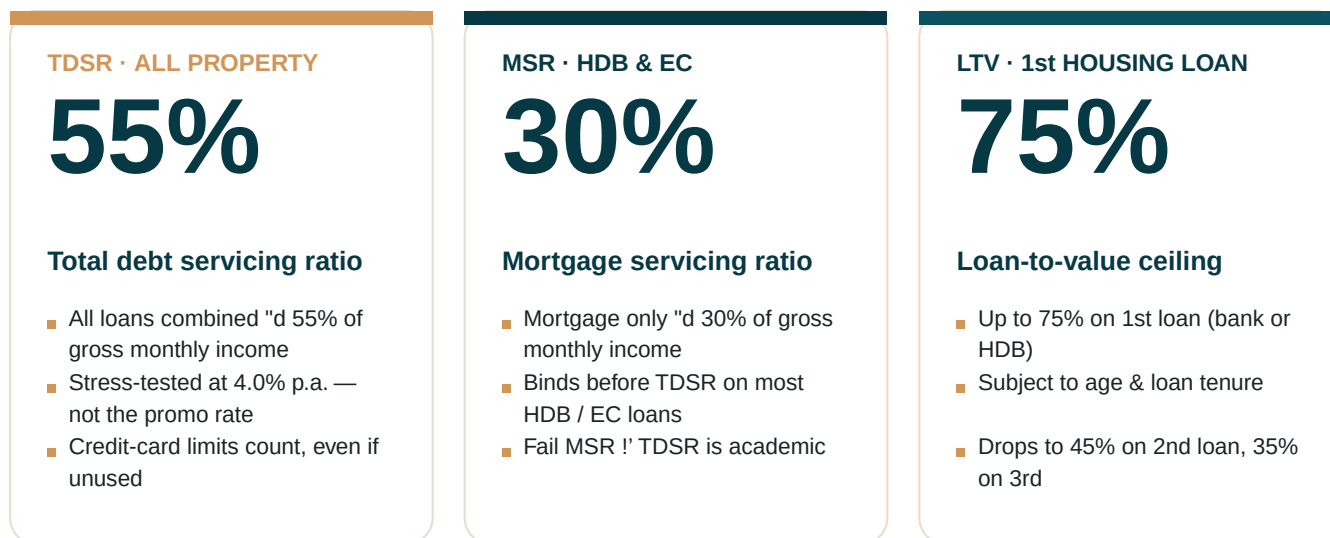
All rates current as at June 2026. Always verify against primary sources before signing.



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What you can actually afford



How the 25% downpayment is structured



WORKED EXAMPLE · \$1.5m property

Cash downpayment (5%)

\$75,000

CPF / Cash (20%)

\$300,000

Bank loan (75%)

\$1,125,000

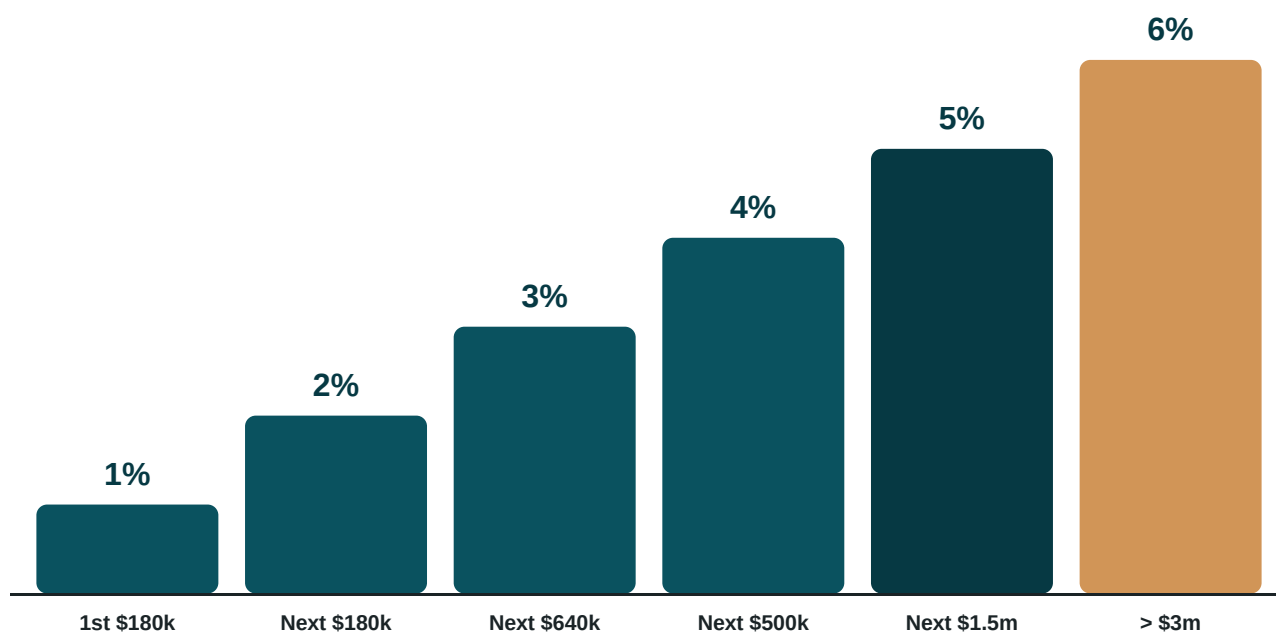


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BSD — tiered and progressive

Computed on the higher of purchase price or market value. Stamped within 14 days of signing the OTP. Funded from cash or CPF.



Quick reckoner

\$1.5 million	"H \$44,600	BSD payable
\$2.5 million	"H \$94,600	BSD payable
\$3.5 million	"H \$154,600	BSD payable (incl. 6% above \$3m)

Source: IRAS Stamp Duty rates (current as at June 2026). Verify on [iras.gov.sg](https://www.iras.gov.sg) before signing.



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ABSD — stacks on top of BSD

Singapore's cooling-measure lever. Layered on top of BSD. Rates current since 27 Apr 2023.

BUYER PROFILE	1ST PROPERTY	2ND PROPERTY	3RD+ PROPERTY
Singapore Citizen	0%	20%	30%
Singapore PR	5%	30%	35%
Foreigner	60%	60%	60%
Entity / Trust	65%	65%	65%

Watch out — the two most expensive misunderstandings

- SC + Foreigner couple buying their FIRST matrimonial home together !' 60% ABSD applies unless the married-couple ABSD remission is claimed.
- FTA nationals (US, Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway, Switzerland) are treated as Singapore Citizens for ABSD — a meaningful save.

Source: IRAS ABSD rates & remission rules (June 2026).



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New Launch Condo (from the developer)

1

Get an IPA from your bank

Required to confirm your loan ceiling. Valid ~30 days. Compare 2–3 banks for headroom.

2

Visit showflat & pick your unit

Most launches publish a balance unit chart by tower, stack, and floor.

3

Pay the 5% booking fee in cash

Developer issues the Option to Purchase (OTP) on the spot.

4

S&P delivered within ~2 weeks

Developer's solicitors send the Sale & Purchase Agreement to your conveyancing lawyer.

5

Exercise OTP within 3 weeks of S&P

Top up downpayment to 25% (5% cash + 20% CPF/cash). Stamp BSD/ABSD within 14 days.

6

Progressive Payment Scheme (PPS)

Remaining 75% drawn progressively as construction hits milestones — foundation, structural, walls, TOP, CSC.



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Resale HDB Flat

1

Apply for the HFE letter — first

HDB Flat Eligibility letter — confirms eligibility, CPF grants, and HDB loan ceiling. Now a prerequisite for OTP.

2

Negotiate & pay the option fee

Typically \$1,000 in cash to the seller. OTP valid for 21 days.

3

Request the HDB valuation

Cash Over Valuation (COV), if any, is paid on top of the valuation in cash.

4

Exercise the OTP

Pay further \$1,000–\$4,000 (option + exercise capped at \$5,000). 8 weeks to completion from here.

5

Submit resale application via HDB portal

Both buyer & seller submit. HDB schedules completion appointment ~8–10 weeks out.

6

Completion: keys & grants

CPF housing grants (EHG, Family, Proximity) disbursed at the completion appointment.



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Resale Private (Condo or Landed)

1

Get your IPA first

Without IPA, negotiation is academic. Compare 2–3 banks.

2

Negotiate the price

Seller's agent issues OTP. Option fee is typically 1% of the purchase price, valid for 14 days.

3

Exercise the OTP

Pay further 4% on exercise (total 5% cash). Stamp BSD/ABSD within 14 days.

4

Conveyancing & due diligence

Your lawyer handles title search, requisitions, and CPF/loan drawdown coordination.

5

Completion in ~8–10 weeks

Balance funds (downpayment + loan) released at completion. Landed property runs longer due to title due diligence.



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5 rules to model BEFORE the OTP

01 HDB MOP (legacy)

Currently own an HDB or EC? Must physically live in it for 5 years before buying private property.

02 BTO Plus / Prime

10-year MOP (not 5) on Plus & Prime BTO categories. Prime flats also carry a subsidy clawback on resale.

03 Foreigner landed

Foreigners need SLA / LDAU prior approval for landed (Sentosa Cove has a streamlined pathway). PRs also subject to LDAU.

04 Cooling measures

TDSR floor, ABSD rates, LTV ratios, BTO classification — all move with the cycle. Confirm against MAS / IRAS / HDB before signing.

REMEMBER

The cheapest mistake is the one you avoid at the showflat.

Every figure in this guide is generalised. Your TDSR is specific to your income mix. Your ABSD depends on your status and your partner's. Your loan ceiling depends on your age at loan maturity. Commit at the showflat on the wrong number and the legal completion will catch it — at your expense.



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Do these in this order

01

☐

Pull your credit bureau report. Pay down or close any small loans / cards you can.

02

☐

Model TDSR and (if HDB/EC) MSR at the 4% stress-test rate. Find your true loan ceiling.

03

☐

Set a realistic cash budget: 5% downpayment + BSD + ABSD + legal (~\$3k) + reno buffer 5–7%.

04

☐

Confirm your ABSD status — especially if either spouse is PR or foreigner. Get a Singapore conveyancing lawyer's opinion before signing.

05

☐

For HDB resale: apply for the HFE letter BEFORE any viewings.

06

☐

For private / new launch: secure an IPA from 2–3 banks for headroom comparison.

07

☐

Shortlist with structure — use the NAVIS PrimeKey 8-pillar framework to compare apples-to-apples.

08

☐

Engage a CEA-registered salesperson and a conveyancing lawyer BEFORE the showflat / viewing — not after.



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Before the OTP — get a second opinion

Every figure in this guide is generalised. Your TDSR, your ABSD, your loan ceiling, your CPF accrued interest — all are specific to you. The cheapest mistake you can make is committing at the showflat on a number that turns out to be wrong on the legal completion date.

FREE FIRST-TIME-BUYER CONSULTATION

A no-pressure walkthrough of your situation.

We will model your TDSR / MSR, sense-check your ABSD, and (if you want) build a structured shortlist using the NAVIS PrimeKey Analysis. One business-day reply, guaranteed.

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